

Element B

Prior Solutions:

jcomas@fsu.edu

Lowery, Logan. "From Studio to Habitat: FSU Art Students Design Interactive Animal Enrichment Toys for Jacksonville Zoo and Botanical Gardens." Florida State University News, 5 Jan. 2026, news.fsu.edu/news/arts-humanities/2026/01/05/from-studio-to-habitat-fsu-art-students-design-interactive-animal-enrichment-toys-for-jacksonville-zoo-and-botanical-gardens/. Accessed 25 Feb.



2026.

Analysis:

Located on the enclosure's floor with a rope with the intended use to act as a tug of war device.

Pros: Can be placed anywhere in the enclosure and used at any time. Does not need the zoo keeper to control and be interactive with the device.

Cons: Doesn't work well with the outline the zookeepers gave us. Does not seem to contain food which is an important exercise motivator.

Komodo Dragon Interactive tug and Pull Toy

“Aussie Dog Zoo Komodo Dragon Interactive Tug and Pull Toy.” Otto Environmental, 9 Oct.

2025,

www.ottoenvironmental.com/product/aussie-dog-zoo-komodo-dragon-interactive-tug-and-pull-toy/. Accessed 25 Feb. 2026.



Analysis: This toy is a tug of war toy which uses a handle, cord, and mouthpiece to keep the dragon entertained. The dragon bites the heavy duty or softer mouthgrip, and the handle is attached to a solid surface or held by the handler. This allows a variety of interactions to occur with one device.

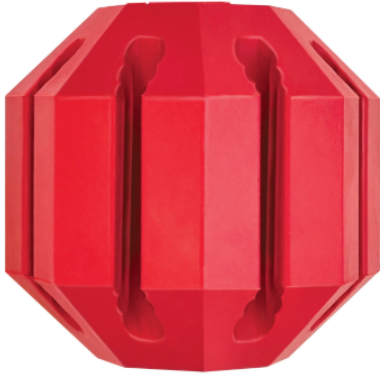
Pros: It can be used in a variety of situations and can lead them to get more exercise.

Cons: It doesn't follow the zoo keepers guidelines and it's not meant for meals.

Kong Stuff-a-Ball

“Kong Stuff-A-Ball.” KONG Company Store, 2026,

www.kongcompany.com/kong-stuff-a-ball/. Accessed 25 Feb. 2026.



Analysis: Rubber or silicone molded toy with the intended use to contain food to stimulate the animal to work for its meals/treats. Has small openings in the sides, top, and bottom of the toy to allow small increments of foods to be obtained over time.

Pros: Holds food well since the food would be surrounded by the toy. Would squeeze like a squishy ball since the material is flexible.

Cons: Doesn't fit with the zoo keepers outline. Not made for feeding large meals at a time. Most likely too weak against serrated teeth and massive talons of the komodo dragons. Too small and not durable enough to be able to withstand the komodo dragons long term.

Pine tree (christmas tree)

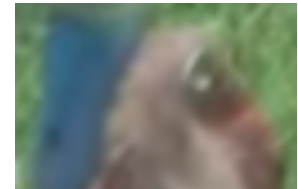
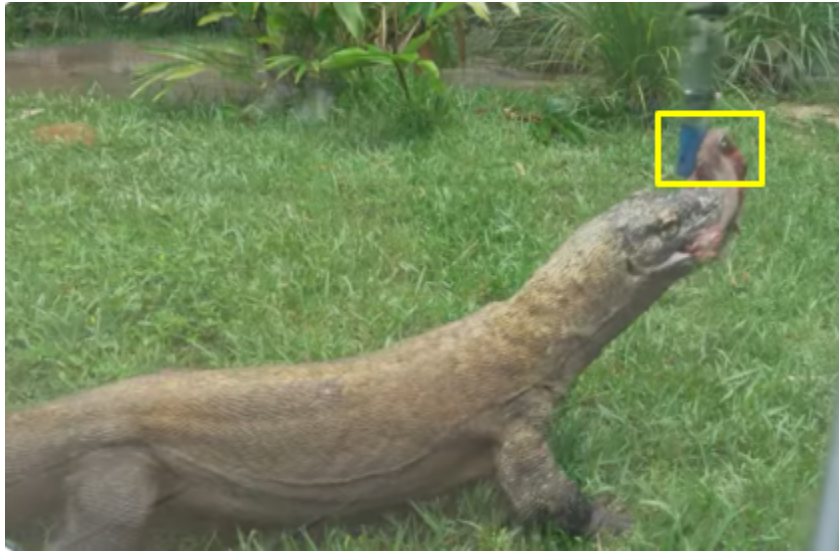


Analysis: From the Komodo dragon handlers at the Nashville zoo, we were informed that they used a christmas tree around winter which has strong scents which are perfect as enrichment toys for the Komodos. They gave it to one komodo dragon, but it wasn't interested in it. When they tried to give it to other komodo dragons, they became interested because they were attracted to the scent of the first komodo dragon that was left behind.

Pros: Another komodo scent on enrichment toys is very beneficial as they become more interested with the enrichment toy to try to rub their own scent on the toy.

Cons: Since the enrichment toy is a tree, it is not very durable and would not last long in the enclosure. In addition, since the toy does not move, it is not as entertaining as other enrichment toys which are mobile.

Brevard Zoo <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hpttC5sBGJ8>



Analysis: This device is a cord hanging down from another mechanism. The cord can swing around, providing another form of flexibility for the device. The flesh is attached to the cord with a screw and a washer (boxed in yellow), keeping the deer carcass attached. This design is low enough to the ground for the komodo dragon to reach the food easily, but the rest of the mechanism is out of reach, protecting the dragon's health.

Pros: This design has the benefits of being able to carry a meal, move around the exhibit, and it can mimic feeding in the wild by simulating a hunt. It also has the benefit that the zookeepers can move it themselves without having to be in the enclosure.

Cons: Contains metal bolts which could possibly be consumed by the komodo dragons if the screws were to come loose and fall off.